NO BARRIERS, AT YOUR OWN PACE: TAILOR-MADE MOBILITY

nexus
a hub for innovation

MARCH 7TH 2026

BEST
TORINO

nexus
a hub for innovation

with the patronage of

CONSIGLIO REGIONALE DEL PIEMONTE

TORINO METROPOLI
Città metropolitana di Torino

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CITTA' DI TORINO

Politecnico di Torino

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01
WHAT IS NEXUS?

NEXUS is a multidisciplinary **competition** conceived by **B.E.S.T.** (Board European Student of Technology) Politecnico di Torino, that involves students from **different backgrounds** (Design, Architecture and even Engineering) who are interested in solving a **creative** challenge mixed with structural credibility.

This competition is an opportunity for students to **test themselves**, **work in a team** and produce a **quality result in a short time**, thus improving their team working skills and problem-solving abilities.

The **themes** of the competition are always chosen among the most common in the fields of **Architecture, Design and Engineering.**

02
PRESENTATION OF THE PROFESSOR

Doctor Cristina Pronello is a full professor at the **Polytechnic University of Turin**, where she coordinates the **Tris** (Transport Research for Innovation and Sustainability) research group.

She held the chair of "Intelligent Transport Systems and Territorial Dynamics" at **Sorbonne Universités** – UTC and was a professor at **Université Lumière Lyon 2**, in the Department of Transport Economics.

She was a member of the **Board of Directors of Ferrovie dello Stato Italiane** and President of the **Regional Transport Authority of the Piedmont Region.**

She coordinated the European H2020 project, **WE-TRANSFORM**, on the impact of transport automation on the workforce.

In December 2020, she founded the innovative start-up **Mobyforall**.

She is the winner of **TRA VISIONS 2020** for the cross-modal section of the competition given to transport innovators, who have carried out highly impactful research funded by the **EU**.

03
DELIVERABLES

Please follow carefully the following **instructions** for the deliverables: the materials that are not fulfilling the requirements will not be considered and will be excluded from the evaluation.

The project delivery must be made through a **link provided by an email** you are going to receive. Each link is accessible only by the members of your own group. In addition to the delivery on the drive it is **mandatory to send a copy** of the uploaded files via **email** to: nexus@*bestorino.com*

The subject of the email should be: *Team number_[PROJECT]_Team name*

*The entries must show **only the team number** and must **not** contain any reference to the authors or team members, otherwise they will be excluded from the competition.*

*The language of all entries **must** be English, under penalty of exclusion.*

Here some details about the deliverable:

File name: *Team number_[PROJ]_Team name*

- *Example: 3_[PROJ]_Horse*

At the end of the day (deadline at **6 p.m. on 7 march**), participants must submit a '**draft**' (max 2 slides) in which they present their project with:

1. sketches (hand-drawn or digital)
2. mood boards (to clearly understand the scope, if necessary)
3. text summarising the project, the target audience, the scope, the environmental impact, sustainability, technical aspects (everything they deem necessary to understand the project in a nutshell)

The final and **complete delivery** of the project will take place the following day (deadline at 11 **p.m. on 8 march**).
Students must submit a maximum of 6 slides in which they will be asked to provide:

1. photographs, renderings, drawings (based on their skills)
2. scope, target audience, context of interest
3. technical and mechanical aspects (also represented graphically)
4. environmental impact, disposal, competitors

The aforementioned **visual presentation** (through drawings, renderings, and the like) is intended to illustrate the **solutio**n you propose, which may include, but **is not limited to**: a vehicle, an architectural solution, a reorganisation of the transport system, or a new logistics route.

Each student should highlight their own contribution as best they can.

04
TOPIC

The question to be answered by the project is:

The city rushes by, but what is our pace? Moving is not just about covering a distance, it is about inhabiting time. So what happens when the transport system is not suited to our needs?

This project explores how to transform transport into a service tailored to people's needs. No more fixed routes, but flexible solutions that take into account those with tight schedules, route preferences or specific accessibility needs. The aim is to redesign the experience of a real-life journey so that it is no longer an obstacle, but a natural extension of the way we live and inhabit space.

The case study took in consideration (and described in the next page) is a real scenario (with changed names), to which we ask you to find a **creative and innovative solution**

Giuseppe is a 23-year-old medical student who lives in Caselle Torinese with his parents. Three times a week, he travels by car as a passenger to study in Orbassano. Giuseppe also drives his car three times a week to go shopping and run various errands, twice for leisure and rarely to give someone a lift. Giuseppe considers his most important journey to be the one from his home to work. Leaving home from Monday to Friday at 8:25 a.m., he manages to get to work at 9:10 a.m.; his journey therefore takes 45 minutes. Giuseppe does not consider his journey particularly fast, but above all he considers it to be rather expensive (he spends around €60/month). In fact, Giuseppe would like to be able to reduce the duration of his journey by 20 minutes.

Furthermore, Giuseppe considers travelling by car as a passenger to be extremely reliable and comfortable, and it allows him to carry items with him. However, he considers this mode of transport to be extremely polluting, unsafe in terms of accidents, and it does not allow him to have enough free time during his commute. Giuseppe is particularly interested in the environmental aspect, to the extent that he is willing to pay as much as €15/month to reduce pollution by 30%. Giuseppe would therefore like to feel more sustainable by using a Mobility Service. At the same time, he would like to be able to count on an integrated, sustainable and safe service.

05
GOALS

Requirements for the project:

The objective of the project is to find a solution to the mobility problem described.

The above solution must be creative (so not necessarily with the standard risolution of MaaS problems) and must comply with all the constraints of the problem, focusing on both feasibility and innovation.

Please note: the target is NOT to produce beautiful IMAGES, but to present the best and most original and innovative CONCEPT IDEAS. Pictures will be considered only as a tool to demonstrate and better explain the ideas presented, thus they will not be judged based on their “aesthetic quality”.

06
EVALUATION CRITERIA

The projects will be evaluated by the jury taking into account the following parameters:

Creativity **(1 - 25)**

Ability to analyze the future passengers needs and desired services, finding innovative and creative solutions in a short time and present them effective- ly by translating them into a proposal. The suitability of the solution to the problem is very important.

Presentation clarity **(1 - 10)**

The proposals must be easy to understand and presented in a logical and clear way.

Solutions implementability **(1 - 10)**

The ideas presented must be technically feasible and - at the same time - expressing innovative and creative solutions that can easily be adopted on production vehicles.

Visual creativity **(1 - 5)**

Projects will be judged based on the creativity shown in the design ideas and their representation.
As already remarked, images will be considered only as a tool to demonstrate and better explain the ideas presented, thus they will not be judged based on their “aesthetic quality”.

07
FAQ

For any question please ask directly to BEST members or Professor Pronello.

For complex questions the professor Cristina Pronello and the Topic Responsible Iris Pasquero will come to answer personally.

What is the maximum score for the deliverables?

The maximum score is 50 points.

What happens if I write down the wrong team number?

If you omit or mistype the team number in the project table or in the file names, you will be excluded from the contest.

08 PRIZES

All winning teams will receive an official competition certificate.

1st PLACE

Ticket for QC Terme and Comix prizes: Roll rucksack, Card Holder and Pencil case

SPA OF WONDERS
TORINO

+

COMIX

2nd PLACE

Comix prize Roll rucksack

COMIX

3rd PLACE

Comix prize Messenger

COMIX

09
RULES

a. Participants must respect the time and way all entries are submitted;

b. Participants must follow the instructions regarding the required materials;

c. Participants must be students enrolled at the Polytechnic of Turin

d. The jury's judgment is unchangable;

e. Participants are forbidden to have any contact with members of the jury on matters relating to the competition;

f. Participation is forbidden for those who have ongoing working or parental relationships with one or more members of the jury;

g. The authorship of each project is attributed equally among all team members;

h. Participation implies full acceptance of the rules, terms and conditions of the notice; in case of non-compliance with these rules the participant and his team will be automatically excluded from the competition;

i. Respect the organizers and the other competitors;

j. Participation in the competition does not entitle CFU.

10
JURY

Your deliveries will be evaluated by a commission composed by the following members:

IRIS PASQUERO

Visit their Linkedin here

CRISTINA PRONELLO

Visit their Linkedin here

Alessandra Boggio Marzet

Visit their Linkedin here

11
SCHEDULE

START	LENGTH	ACTIVITY
08:30	30 min	Welcoming in Aula Emma Strada, check-in
9:00	1 hour	NEXUS Official Opening ceremony in Aula Emma Strada and topic exposition
10:00	20 min	End of the Official Opening, Moving to 27b - 29b classrooms
10:30	1 hour	Coffee Break
11:30	2 hours	Beginning of working hours
13:30	1 hour	Lunch
14:30	3 hours 30 min	Working hours
18:00	1 hour	Aperitivo

THE END OF THE DAY

GOOD LUCK AND ENJOY THE CHALLENGE!

BEST TORINO